SATHAPANA BANK

Campus Innovator Challenge

Reimaging Banking for Gen Z

Under Future of Finance 2026

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About Sathapana Bank

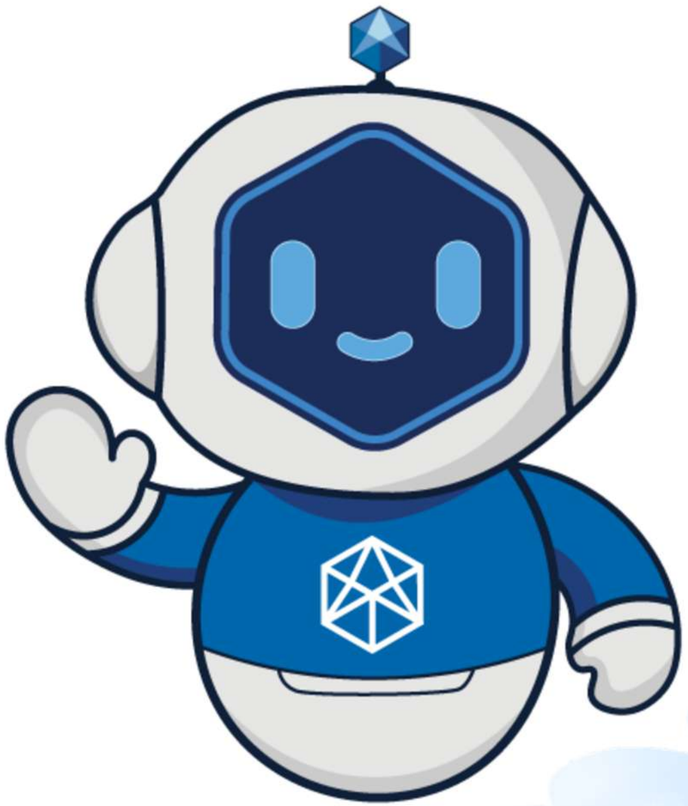
Sathapana Bank Plc. originated from MARUHAN Corporation, founded in 1957 by Han Chang-Woo. In 2008, MARUHAN launched MARUHAN Japan Bank Plc., the first Japanese-owned bank in Cambodia, to support local entrepreneurs and microfinance institutions. After acquiring Sathapana Limited in 2012, the two merged in 2016 to create Sathapana Bank Plc., which now offers reliable banking services and promotes economic development in Cambodia.

Vision

To be the bank of choice
To be the employer of choice

Mission

Building a brighter future by placing clients at the heart of everything we do, exceeding customer expectations, offering innovative financial solutions and forging sustainable community relationships.



Future of Finance: Campus Edition

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A university program aims to **provide students with practical financial knowledge and innovation skills through real-world applications**. It features hands-on workshops and student challenges in partnership with other universities.

Project Objectives

Build Practical Financial Capability

Financial skills, including money management, digital banking usage, and informed financial decision-making

Integrate Experiential Learning on Campus

Hands-on workshop and challenges that allow students to apply financial innovation and problem-solving skills

Expose Students to Future Finance Careers

Connect students with banking, FinTech, and innovation professionals through specialist trainers and industry engagement

Strengthen University-Industry Collaboration

Provide scalable, outcome-focused student programs that enhance employability and career readiness

DEFINE "GENERATION Z"

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The first generation to be fully digital-native—not "good with tech," but raised inside an always-on stream of feeds, notifications, and comparisons.

THE WORLD THAT SHAPES THEM

1997 – 2002

Born Into Connectivity

- Internet already mainstream
- Technology is assumed not appreciated

2003 – 2007

Social Media Emerges

- Facebook, YouTube enter daily life
- Online identity forms

2008 – 2010

Global Financial Crisis

- Parents affected by the layout
- Security over blind loyalty

2011 – 2019

Smartphones & Visual Culture

- Smartphones, Instagram & Snapchat
- Visual-first communication

2020 – 2022

COVID Disruption

- Isolation + digital dependency
- Mental health prioritized

2023 –PRESENT

AI & Uncertain Futures

- AI threatens
- Cautious optimism
- Side hustles & rise of the gig economy

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Do innovators always need to start their own company, or can they create impact from inside an organization?

Intrapreneurship vs. Entrepreneurship

Challenge Overview

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The Sathapana Campus Innovators Challenge invites university students to innovate banking services for the next generation. It aims to foster student innovation and intrapreneurship, understand Gen Z financial behaviors, and strengthen engagement with university communities.

Learning Journey for Students

Stage 1:
Awareness

- Learn how banking services support and digital banking in daily financial activities
- **How do young people interact with financial services today?**

Stage 2:
Experience

- Explore the banking journey from the user's perspective
- **What is the experience of using modern banking services as a young customer?**

Stage 3:
Problem Discovery

- Analyze the common challenges among university students
- **What are the financial behaviors or challenges exist and worth solving?**

Stage 4:
Innovation

- Propose a concept that improves financial services for young users
- **How can financial service evolve to better serve next generation?**

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Current Industry Finance Economy

10M	600M	21M
Cambodians use mobile banking	Transactions in 2024 via Bakong	Deposit accounts exists accross FIs

Meanwhile, Sathapana Bank is one of Cambodia's major commercial banks:

- US$2.7 billion in assets
- 175 branches and more than 300 ATMs nationwide
- Strong mobile banking ecosystem and retail banking services.

This creates a huge opportunity for innovation in youth banking and digital engagement.

Opportunity for innovation in youth banking and digital engagement

#1 Problem Statement

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If Sathapana aims to become your "go-to-bank" over the next three years, what should we improve or change to better serve young customers like you?

- What values matter to you most when choosing a bank?
- What type of content would make you more likely to engage with a bank on platforms (e.g., TikTok or Instagram)?
- What kind of content from SPN would make you feel proud to share or repost on your own social media?

#2 Problem Statement

How can Sathapana Bank design or position its financial products to better match your needs, behaviors, and lifestyles?

- What is the #1 moment you need banking support the most as a student? (E.g., tuition, allowance, daily expenses, etc.)?
- What challenges do you face when managing money during university life?
- If SPN could integrate with one app you use every day, which app would add the most value to your daily life?

Challenge Timeline

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01

Campus Briefing

- Introduction to Future of Finance
- Explanation of Campus Innovator Challenge
- Reveal Bank Problem Statements

March 6th, 2026

02

Innovation Sprint

- Form a team of up to 3 members.
- Create a concept idea, feature or product idea, educational or campaign idea, user journey, simple prototype, or storyboard.

03

Submission

- **12 main slides**
- Requirements:
  - Problem understanding
  - Target user
  - Proposed solution
  - Justification for effectiveness

March 29th, 2026 at 11:59 PM

04

Evaluation & Recognition

- 3 teams will pitch for 7 minutes in the semi-finals at Anakot Lab
  - 8-minute Q&A
  - Judges will evaluate
- Certificates & gifts will be awarded

April 3rd, 2026

05

Cross-Campus Final Round

- One top team from all 4 universities receives an invitation to the final episode of Future of Finance S1
- Present their final pitch to executive management and partners

April 8th, 2026

Benefits for Students

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Top Innovators (1st)

Selected team at the inter-university competition

Apple iPad 11th A16

A16 Chip 128GB WiFi

Outstanding Innovators (2nd)

SONY WH-CH720N

Wireless Bluetooth
Noise-Cancelling Headphones

Promising Innovators (3rd)

Anker Zolo Power Bank

10K 30W with built-in USB-C

Emerging Innovators (4th)

Anker Soundcore P20i

Bluetooth5.3 with 30h Playtime

Access exclusive Sathapana merchandise, certificates of acknowledgment, upcoming talent initiatives, and interact with executive management.

Evaluation Criteria

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- **Problem Statement (20%)**
  - How well does the team understand the challenge?
- **Innovation & Creativity (20%)**
  - How original and creative is the idea?
- **Relevance to Young Customer (20%)**
  - How well does the idea address the needs of Gen Z?
- **Business Value (20%)**
  - How beneficial is the idea for the banking industry?
- **Feasibility & Implementation (10%)**
  - How practical is the idea?
- **Presentation & Communication (10%)**
  - How effectively is the idea presented?

How to Submit?

- Email: chhun.phalanady@sathapana.com.kh
- Subject: AUPP Application for Campus Innovator Challenge
- Must include:
  - Full names of team members
  - Academic year and major
  - Telegram and email addresses of all members
  - Attach PDF file (File Label: *Group Name_AUPP CIC*)

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Reimagine Banking for Gen Z

with Sathapana Bank

Under Future of Finance 2026